

Compensation AI Acceptable Use Guideline Canvas

Section 2 — Target Audience

- **Name/roles:** Compensation staff, including Compensation Analysts, senior analysts, and the Compensation Manager.
- **Current AI fluency (1–5):** 1–2; most use is limited to basic drafting or light experimentation rather than structured workflow design.
- **What they need:** A clear, unit-specific guide explaining what AI use is permitted, restricted, documentable, and reviewable in Compensation work.
- **Likely concern:** That the guideline will either be too vague to help or too restrictive to be practical in daily Compensation work.

Section 1 — Problem Statement

Compensation increasingly encounters AI in drafting tools and vendor platforms, but lacks unit-specific guidance on permitted uses, restricted uses, documentation, and human review. This creates inconsistency, avoidable risk, and uncertainty for staff handling applicant, employee, and pay-related work across the Compensation unit.

Section 3 — AI Tools and Approach

- **Tool 1:** U of A GenAI.
 - Modality: Text-based AI assistant.
 - Rationale: Institutionally governed tool already relevant to drafting, summarizing, and structured Compensation/HR support tasks.
 - Data sensitivity: Depends on use case; Compensation work may involve medium to high sensitivity.
 - Institutional approval: Yes, institutionally available/approved environment.
- **Tool 2:** AI features embedded in approved vendor systems such as JDXpert, PayScale MarketPay, and [Monday.com](https://www.monday.com/).
 - Modality: Embedded AI drafting, suggestion, matching, or workflow-assist features.
 - Rationale: These tools are already part of Compensation workflows, so the guideline must govern staff behavior in them too.

- Data sensitivity: Medium to high depending on whether job, employee, or compensation data is involved.
- Institutional approval: Platform-level approval depends on institutional/vendor governance; use must still follow Compensation and UA rules.

Section 4 — Ethical Safeguards

- **Risk:** Sensitive applicant or employee data is entered into an unapproved or inappropriate AI context.
 - Safeguard: Restrict identifiable data from unapproved tools and require staff to use only approved environments for governed use cases.
 - Responsible party: Compensation staff using the tool, with oversight from the Compensation Manager.
- **Risk:** AI output is treated as authoritative for classification, MQ, or pay-related judgments.
 - Safeguard: State clearly that AI may support drafting or analysis but may not serve as the sole basis for decisions.
 - Responsible party: Compensation analysts and manager.
- **Risk:** AI use is hidden or inconsistently documented.
 - Safeguard: Require significant AI use to be logged in trackers, workflow records, or analysis memos, including tool, purpose, and human review.
 - Responsible party: Compensation staff creating the output.

Section 5 — Equity Considerations

- **Population 1:** Applicants or employees with non-traditional backgrounds whose context may be flattened by AI-assisted review.
 - Adjustment: Preserve human review and prohibit sole reliance on AI for high-stakes decisions.
- **Population 2:** Compensation staff with different levels of AI fluency.
 - Adjustment: Use plain-language definitions and practical examples so the guideline reduces confusion rather than assuming technical knowledge.

Section 6 — Success Metrics

- **Metric 1:** Staff understanding of permitted vs restricted AI use.
 - How measured: Short manager or team review of sample use cases.
 - Timeline: Within 30–60 days of sharing the guideline.
 - Minimum acceptable threshold: Most staff can correctly classify core sample scenarios.
- **Metric 2:** Documentation compliance for significant AI use.
 - How measured: Spot-check unit records or sample memos for tool, purpose, and human review notes.
 - Timeline: Within 60–90 days.
 - Minimum acceptable threshold: Clear documentation appears in a strong majority of material AI-assisted cases.
- **Metric 3:** Leadership usability of the draft.
 - How measured: Feedback from the Compensation Manager on whether the guideline is practical enough to adapt rather than rewrite from scratch.
 - Timeline: First review cycle.
 - Minimum acceptable threshold: Leadership sees it as a usable starting point.

Section 7 — Rollout Plan — First Three Steps

- **Step 1:** Finalize the draft so scope, definitions, disclosure, and examples are internally consistent.
 - Who: Gina.
 - Resource needed: Current guideline draft and unit examples.
 - By what date: Within 1 week.
- **Step 2:** Share the draft with the Compensation Manager and one senior analyst for practical review.
 - Who: Gina, Leah, and one senior analyst.
 - Resource needed: Clean draft and short cover note.
 - By what date: Within 2–3 weeks.
- **Step 3:** Revise the draft based on feedback into a manager-ready version.

- Who: Gina.
- Resource needed: Reviewer comments.
- By what date: Within 30 days.

50-word elevator pitch

This initiative creates a Compensation AI Acceptable Use Guideline that defines what staff may and may not do with AI in Compensation work, how significant use is documented, and where human review is required. It gives the unit a practical governance starting point for responsible AI use with sensitive data.